STORMTROOPER KIT

As assault troops, who launched near-continual raids on Allied trenches during the spring of 1918, German stormtroopers were constantly on the move. Everything about their kit and weaponry was designed to facilitate rapid mobility, ease of use, and ready access in the heat of battle – from the crowded utility belt and assault pack (which contained everything from food and water to ammunition and temporary shelter) to the grenade bag and specially shortened Mauser KAR98AZ carbine.

Helmet
All armies were obliged to equip infantry with steel helmets in the course of World War I. The German "Stahlhelm" was introduced in 1916. Its distinctive "coal-scuttle" shape protected the back of the neck.

World War I soldiers were among the first to use camouflage on a widespread basis.

Ribbon from iron cross – second class

Tunic
This standard-issue stormtrooper tunic provided great warmth but would have been very heavy, especially when wet. Many stormtroopers covered their epaulettes with a strip of cloth, so the enemy would not see their regimental badge.

Shovel blade for trench digging

Badge indicating soldier had been wounded

Iron cross – first class

Zeltbahn (rain poncho)

Assault pack
Worn as a backpack, this compact kit featured a pioneer shovel, a *zeltbahn* (a large rain poncho that could also be used as a tent), and a container of cooking utensils, the lid of which doubled as a frying pan – all bound together tightly with leather straps.



The assault pack, as worn around the back for ease of transportation



The Mauser KAR98AZ, the stormtrooper's principal weapon



Equipment pouches and canvas sack for holding grenades